



MONTHLY UPDATE

Use of satellite data: monthly update, August 2026

Edition of 2026-09-03 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

16 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

BURUNDI · COMOROS · CONGO · EGYPT · GHANA · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MALI · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER
· RWANDA · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · TANZANIA · ZAMBIA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Burundi

The national mapping and meteorological institute put two standing capabilities on the record. Its service page names identifying and managing agricultural, urban and protected areas among the four purposes of Burundian cartography, and states that mapping has modernised through remote sensing, satellite positioning, geographic information systems and drones, and it publishes a satellite imagery viewer whose named dynamic layers are geostationary precipitation, infrared and convection products on automatic update. Both are descriptions of what the institute does rather than dated events, and they are the first the base holds.

Comoros

The food and agriculture organisation's earth observation portal publishes vegetation, agricultural stress, drought and precipitation indicators for the Comoros, derived from two polar-orbiting satellite series and from external precipitation estimates. The system covering the country is not the country's: it is not established as government-operated, and no Comorian ministry or agency is named anywhere on file as using its outputs. The page is a live dashboard, dated by the day it was retrieved.

Congo

The national mapping institute began putting its own holdings into a usable form. On 11 August it signed a framework partnership with a local non-governmental organisation to digitise, secure and disseminate its geospatial and cartographic data, building a shared platform for public, institutional and research access. It is a framework agreement rather than a delivered platform: no term, funding, licence or access rule is stated, and nothing says what is currently held or in what form.

Egypt

A trilateral memorandum with Japan's land and agriculture ministries covers joint research and the application of artificial intelligence to monitoring water structures and flood risk, with Egypt intending to use a Japanese satellite rainfall product across Nile basin states. No money, date or named system is stated, and the instrumentation targets are old physical structures, the barrages first.

Ghana

Two satellite-derived systems were [named as live deployments at a university lecture reported on 10 August](#): an agricultural information and monitoring system, and a national forest monitoring system paired with a deforestation tracker built toward European deforestation-regulation compliance for cocoa and gold supply chains. Both are named by their builder, and no coverage, accuracy, user or funding figure is published for either.

Liberia

The Land Authority took the country's geospatial ambition abroad rather than to a budget. At the United Nations' sixteenth global geospatial information management session in August it [sought international partnerships and technical support to build a National Spatial Data Infrastructure](#) — a coordinated geospatial framework for land administration, mapping and national planning. It is an approach for support rather than a programme: no funding, custodian, standard or timetable is stated, and the base still holds no earth-observation or geospatial data programme of any kind.

Libya

On 4 August the Libyan Authority for Scientific Research [discussed launching a first Libyan satellite for climate and desertification monitoring](#), at design stage with no budget, timetable, launch partner or procurement route stated.

Mali

Work is under way to [finalise the creation by decree of an integrated national measurement, reporting and verification system](#) for the nationally determined contribution. No decree number, data source list or operator is on file.

Mozambique

A development-bank and Korean-financed programme has left a standing national flood-mapping capability: [nine LiDAR-equipped drone systems, simulators, unmanned surface vessels and data platforms, with 30 specialists from the meteorology institute, the disaster management institute, the cartography and remote-sensing centre, the roads administration and the water directorate certified in July](#). The cohort was deployed half-trained into the January 2026 Marracuene floods, which the district recorded with no loss of life. The account is the financing bank's own, and it states no running cost, custodian institution or arrangement for sharing the mapping output.

Namibia

China [handed over a satellite data-receiving ground station at the earth station outside Windhoek, Namibia's first, receiving remote-sensing data and operated by fourteen trained Namibians](#). The handover date is inferred from a weekday named in a report published the next day, and no operating agreement, data-sharing term or ownership arrangement is held.

Niger

The national geographic institute [runs a remote-sensing unit producing Sentinel-based imagery for forest, land-use and territorial monitoring, and describes itself as an exclusive satellite-imagery distributor in several countries](#). No programme name, partner or date is published, and the page carries no date of its own, so the position is dated to retrieval rather than to any event.

Rwanda

A [national satellite data programme launched with a commercial imagery provider on 10 August](#), giving government agencies, public universities, selected startups and development partners access to near-daily imagery for agriculture and food-security monitoring, forest health, urban planning and disaster response, managed by the space agency. It was announced jointly by vendor and government, and no cost, term, data-licence arrangement, contract or appropriation is held.

Sierra Leone

DSTI announced on 4 August that it is [developing a national base map with the Ministry of Lands, with JICA support and Japanese technical direction, phase one covering Western Area Urban District](#). No cost, timetable, hosting arrangement or data licence is stated.

Somalia

Earth observation here is a service rather than a programme, and the record caught up with it this month rather than the service changing. A partner information unit [operates high, medium and low-resolution satellite imagery to estimate cultivable area and production, map land use and cover, monitor irrigation infrastructure and track land degradation](#), and its routine output — [a national monthly vegetation index series extended through July 2026, mapping deficits against short-term averages](#) — is published without interruption. No Somali public body operates an equivalent capability, and the strategic plan for a national meteorological agency, released in December 2025, has not yet produced one.

Tanzania

A research capability ended rather than started. The three-year Precision Livestock Farming project, run by a national institution with a foreign university and foundation funding, [closed on 27 August and presented its results](#). Nothing in the record held says the work continues under national funding, which is the question a closing donor project always raises.

Zambia

Weather data for aviation is being examined rather than improved. The Civil Aviation Authority and the International Civil Aviation Organisation [launched an assessment to strengthen aviation weather data](#). What the assessment starts from is not stated: the record held carries nothing on what meteorological data Zambia currently produces, from which sources, or how it reaches the people flying.

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.